imagery and form, especially in one instance when she uses an extra spatial pause to add another site, this time of destination and return: “Washington bound again.” Notions of fear and leaving are enacted at the center of the American capital as well as along the margins of its militarized borders in Mexico, Germany, and elsewhere. Lorde suggests diaspora as a means of finding home while on the verge of or in the midst of the state of exile.

A nightmare in this poem, like the dream in “Berlin Is Hard on Colored Girls,” is again a location of furtive movement, albeit in pronounced danger. But rather than the return to slumber or potential for intimacy, in “Diaspora” she pushes toward a state of chaotic and exigent movement at its close, leaning toward self-preservation. Her linkage of escape and movement across national borders incorporates numerous geopolitical contexts and courses of escape. Lorde blurs distinct geographies toward a mapping of the shared conditions of global division. The poem closes as its unnamed protagonist wakes and “gulps carbon monoxide in a false-bottomed truck” as she finds herself transgressing borders and fording rivers, “grenades held dry in a calabash / leaving.” The image of a grenade hidden in a hollowed-out gourdlike fruit implies impending doom as well as a strategic form of resistance—and the chance of nourished liberation through flight. The last line as a single word, “leaving,” enjambed and left hanging, pushes for further ambiguity. Leaving becomes a mode for Lorde in the poem to imagine movement without closure, a way of pointing and directing readers’ attention beyond the poem, out into the world. To do so, she conjures a collective vision of a woman furtively crossing national borders to be cast into limbo, who interacts with Lorde through a dream. Diaspora is conjured through modes of border crossing and identification, dreams and geopolitical maneuvering, which bring about possibility through uncertainty, a recoding of the borderlands and practices of survival.

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Between the writing and publication phases of *Our Dead Behind Us* in 1986, U.S. Cold War policy and the question of militaristic reach across national borders were matters of significant political debate. Reagan worked with newly appointed general secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union Mikhail Gorbachev on missile treaties (including the Intermediate Range Nuclear Forces treaty), while simultaneously spiking rhetoric and policy around fears of a continued communist threat. Gorbachev, meanwhile,